

CAPTCHA Hax With TesseractCap

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Content

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With the goal of creating a tool that can help security professionals and developers to test their CAPTCHA schemes, I conducted a research on over 200 high traffic websites and several CAPTCHA service providers listed on [Quantcast's Top 1 Million Ranking Websites](#).

During the same time frame, students at the Stanford University also conducted a similar [research \(PDF\)](#). Both research works concluded the obvious:

An alarming number of CAPTCHAs schemes are vulnerable to automated attacks.

I looked around, tested and zeroed in on Tesseract-OCR as my OCR engine. To remove color complexities, spatial irregularities, and other types of random noise from CAPTCHAs, I decided to write my own image preprocessing engine. After a few months of research, coding and testing in my spare time, TesseractCap was born and is ready for release now.

TesseractCap is a GUI based, point and shoot CAPTCHA analysis tool with the following features:

- A generic image preprocessing engine that can be configured as per the CAPTCHA type being analyzed.
- Tesseract-OCR as its OCR engine to retrieve text from preprocessed CAPTCHAs.
- Web proxy support
- Support for custom HTTP headers to retrieve CAPTCHAs from websites that require cookies or special HTTP headers in requests
- CAPTCHA statistical analysis support
- Character set selection for the OCR Engine

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